



# THE LANGUAGE GAZETTE

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Words That Shaped Me:  
Language Mentors and Lessons

# ***MEET THE TEAM***

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Ms. Twisha Ray







# Editorial

Languages have shaped me in ways I didn't see coming. I didn't wake up one day and say, "Hey, I'll learn Chinese, Japanese, Taiwanese, and Cantonese." It just... happened. One language led to another, one person led to a new world. And somewhere along the way, I became that person — who switches between four languages mid-conversation and still forgets where I kept my phone.

The first thing I picked up fluently? The curse words, obviously. Honestly, that's how I bonded with most locals. You drop a perfectly timed swear word in someone's mother tongue, and boom! instant friendship. It doesn't matter what country you're in. Nothing says "I get you" like a shared laugh over a well-placed F-bomb.

My earliest memory of falling in love with language wasn't through a textbook. It was someone casually explaining the word "家" (jiā) in Chinese—home—made up of a roof

and a pig underneath it. That blew my mind. Like, this wasn't just grammar. This was life, values, tradition. Suddenly, words weren't words. They were entire universes.

Japanese gave me structure. Every time my sensei corrected my "は" and "が" I'd sigh, but damn if it didn't train my brain to think more clearly. Taiwanese was like being hugged by a language warm, familiar, and full of heart. Cantonese? That one was wild. It came at me fast, full of emotion and attitude.

Of course, there were awkward moments, like when I accidentally mixed up "wife" and "stomach" in Japanese. (Let's just say, it did not land well with the host family.) But those mess-ups were part of the magic. They made me humble, human, and funny, apparently.

What really shaped me, though, weren't just the words; it was the people. The mentors who taught me with tough love, the random strangers who corrected me mid-sentence, and the friends who laughed with me and at me. Through them, I learned that language isn't just about fluency; it's about connection.

So yeah, words shaped me. But more than that, they opened me up to people, to stories, and to my own weird, multilingual, ever-evolving self.

**Mr. Soham Kakade**  
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# *My Journey with Ewan Business Solutions*

Working at Ewan Business Solutions as a Marketing and Support Executive has been an incredibly rewarding experience. Over time, I've had the opportunity to work closely with both the marketing and operations teams, which has not only helped me grow professionally but has also deepened my understanding of the language and localization industry.

From day one, I was entrusted with responsibilities that allowed me to contribute meaningfully to the company's growth. Coordinating between departments, managing student queries, and supporting batch schedules helped me sharpen my communication and organizational skills. Collaborating with the marketing team enhanced my creativity, allowing me to work on campaigns that effectively reached the right audience. Meanwhile, working with the operations team gave me insight into the strategic side of execution, ensuring smooth workflows and timely reporting.

One of the most enriching parts of my journey has been supporting projects across multiple languages. This multicultural exposure has broadened my perspective and helped me adapt to the dynamic needs of a diverse clientele. Whether it was responding to learner queries, scheduling meetings, or facilitating communication between teachers and students, each task contributed to the overall success of Ewan's training programs.

This role has taught me the importance of collaboration, accountability, and continuous learning. Being part of a team that's passionate, dedicated, and focused on delivering excellence has been a source of strength and motivation for me. I'm proud to have played a part in supporting Ewan's mission of providing high-quality training and building strong industry connections.



Looking ahead, I'm excited to continue contributing to Ewan Business Solutions and being a part of its journey toward even greater success.

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# শব্দের শক্তি : ভাষার পথ



ভাষা এক আর্থ শক্তি —যা অনপ্রুপেরণা দি তে পারে , শি া দান করতে পারে , এমনকি পরি বর্তনও আনতে পারে । আমার জীবনে ভাষার পথদর্শকে রা এমনই এক আল ো হয়ে উঠে ছে ন, যাঁদে র শব্দে মি শে রয়ে ছে দি কনি র্দে শনা, া ও আবি কাশে র উপকরণ। এই লে খায় আমি অশ্বে ষণ করব, কী কী শি া আমি তাঁদে র কাছ থে কে পে য়ে ছি এবং কীভাবে তা আমার জগতে র ব োধ ও উপলব্ধি কে গড়ে তুলে ছে ।

## গ বলার উপহার

শৈশবে আমার ঠামা আমাকে শ ো নাতে ন আমাদে র পরি বার-পররার গ, সৃষ্টি র কথা ও তাঁর জীবনে র সংগমে র ৃতি । তাঁর শল ো ছি ল স্নে হ, রসি কতা আর া য় ব ো না এক অনপুম জাল—যা আমাকে শি থি য়ে ছি ল, কাহি নি বলার মধ্যে ই লকিকিয়ে আছে মানষুেষের সঙ্গে সংয োগ গড়ার আর আমাদে র ঐতি হ রার এক অনন পা। এই গল োর মধ দি য়ে আমি অনভু ব করতে শি থে ছি লাম সহানভুতি র , জীবনে র দঢ় তা এবং মানষুেষের চি রন অভিতা।

## এক পথদর্শকে র উরাধি কার

আমার জীবনে র এক অনতম ভাষা- ছি লে ন আমার ইংরে জি শি ক্ষি কা। সাহি ত্যে র তি তাঁর অনরুগ ছি ল সংমক, আর তাঁর শি া দান ছি ল চালে গ্লে ভরপুর, তবুদতাপূর্ণাৰ্ণ তি নি আমাকে অনুাণি ত করে ছি লে ন নানা ঘরানার সাহি ত পড়তে , বি ভি লে খকে র সঙ্গে পরি চি ত হতে , এবং শৈ লীর বৈ চি বঝু তে । তাঁর ভাবে আমি চি া করার দৃষ্টিভঙ্গি ও লে খার দতা অর্জন করি । এই উরাধি কার কে বল শ্রে ণি কক্ষে সীমাব থাকে নি — তি নি আমার মধ্যে জাগি য়ে দি য়ে ছি লে ন শে খার তি ভাল োবাসা এবং ভাষার অসীম শক্তি র তি গভীর া।

## য োগায োগে র শি

আমার ভাষা-রা আমাকে শি থি য়ে ছে ন, য োগায োগ কে বল তথ আদানদানে র মাধম নয়—এ সর্ক গড়ার, দৃষ্টিভঙ্গি ব োঝার এবং জল সামাজি ক পরি স্থি তি সামলান োর এক ক ৌশল। আমি উপলব্ধি করতে শি থে ছি , ভাষায় সুরে র সূতা, সঙ্গে র গভীরতা ও বর্ণনর্ণ ার অনরুগন কতটা পূর্ণাৰ্ণ ত্যে ক পরি স্থি তি , শ্র োতা ও উদ্দে শ্যে র সাথে তাল মি লি য়ে নি জে র ভাষাকে গড়ে ত োলার ক ৌশলও তাঁদে র কাছ থে কে ই শে খা।

## শি ার ধারা

আমার ভাষা-পথদর্শকদে র কাছ থে কে পাওয়া অমলু কি ছুশি া এইরকম:

- ভাষার অনপ্রুপেরণা ও শি া দান করার মতা:

ভাষা মানষুকে উু করতে পারে , চালে জানাতে পারে , এবং একাভাবে বদলে দি তে পারে ।

- সহানভুতি ও ব োঝাপড়ার য োজনীয়তা:

ভাষা হতে পারে মানষুেষের মধ্যে সে তুবনে র এক বলি মাধম—সৃষ্টি , অভিতা আর চি াধারার বি নি ময়ে র পথ।

- তা ও নি র্ভুলতার মলু:

সফল য োগায োগে র জন ভাষার তি য, সঙ্গে র প্রে ক্ষি তে শচয়নে র সূতা অত জরি ।







### উপসংহার

শেষ কথায়, আমার ভাষা-পথদর্শকদের শলি আমার জীবন ও জগৎ-বোধে এক অগাধ ভাব ফেলেছে। তাঁরা আমাকে শিখিয়েছেন গবলার মাহা, সহানুভূতির শক্তি, এবং ভাষার মধু দিয়ে মানুষকে ঊর করার গা। আমি যখন ভাষার সঙ্গে আমার নিজের যাপথে এগিয়ে চলেছি, তখন আমি কৃতসেই শিখার তিরতি, আর কৃতসেই পথদর্শকদের তিরতি যাঁরা আমায় দিশা দেয়িত্তিয়েছেন।

### এক জীবনব্যাপী যাত্রা

ভবিষ্যতে রদিকে তাকিয়ে আমি উত্থু হয়ে আছি ভাষার অপার সাবনাকে আবিষ্কার করার জন-ভাষার শক্তি ও সাবনাকে আরও গভীরভাবে বর্ণনার জন। আমি আশাবাদী, আমি এই শিখা অনদের মাঝে ও ছড়িয়ে দিতে পারব-ভাষাকে একসে তুকের গড়ে তুলতে পারব সর্ক, সহানুভূতি আর বোধাপড়ার জগৎ। যে শলি আমাকে গড়ে তুলেছে, তারাই হয়ত আমায় পথ দেখাবে আজীবন চলার এই যাপথে।

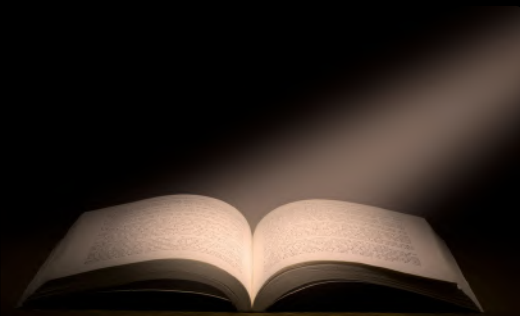


# The Power of Words: How Language Mentors Shaped My World

Language has the power to inspire, to educate, and to transform. For me, the words of my language mentors have been a source of guidance, wisdom, and growth. In this article, I will explore the lessons I've learned from my language mentors and how they have shaped my understanding of the world.

## The Gift of Storytelling

Growing up, my grandmother would regale me with stories of our family's history, cultural traditions, and personal struggles. Her words were woven with love, humor, and wisdom, and they taught me the value of storytelling as a way to connect with others and preserve our heritage. Through her stories, I learned about the importance of empathy, resilience, and the human condition.



## A Mentor's Legacy

One of my most influential language mentors was my English teacher. She had a passion for literature that was contagious, and her teaching style was both challenging and supportive. She encouraged me to explore different genres, authors, and styles, and she helped me develop my critical thinking and writing skills. Her legacy extends far beyond the classroom, as she instilled in me a love of learning and an appreciation for the power of language.



## The Art of Communication

Through my language mentors, I've learned that communication is not just about conveying information, but about building relationships, understanding perspectives, and navigating complex social situations. I've come to appreciate the importance of tone, nuance, and context in language, and I've learned to adapt my communication style to different audiences and purposes.

## Lessons Learned

Some of the most valuable lessons I've learned from my language mentors include:

**The power of language to inspire and educate:** Language has the ability to motivate, to challenge, and to transform us.

**The importance of empathy and understanding:** Language can be a powerful tool for building bridges between people and cultures.

**The value of clarity and precision:** Effective communication requires careful attention to language, tone, and context.

### Conclusion

In conclusion, the words of my language mentors have had a profound impact on my life and my understanding of the world. They have taught me the value of storytelling, the importance of empathy and understanding, and the power of language to inspire and educate. As I continue on my own journey with language, I am grateful for the lessons I've learned and the mentors who have guided me along the way.



### A Lifelong Journey

As I look to the future, I am excited to continue exploring the possibilities of language and to deepen my understanding of its power and potential. I hope to pass on the lessons I've learned to others, and to use language as a tool for building connections, fostering empathy, and promoting understanding. The words that have shaped me will continue to inspire and guide me on this lifelong journey.

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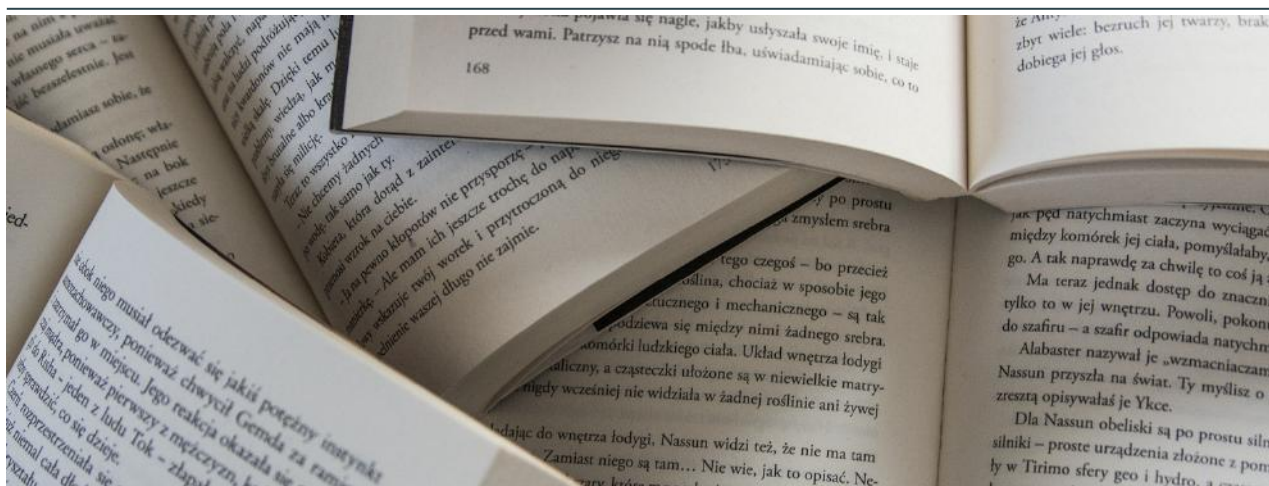


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# WORDS THAT SHAPED ME:

## Language Mentors and Lessons

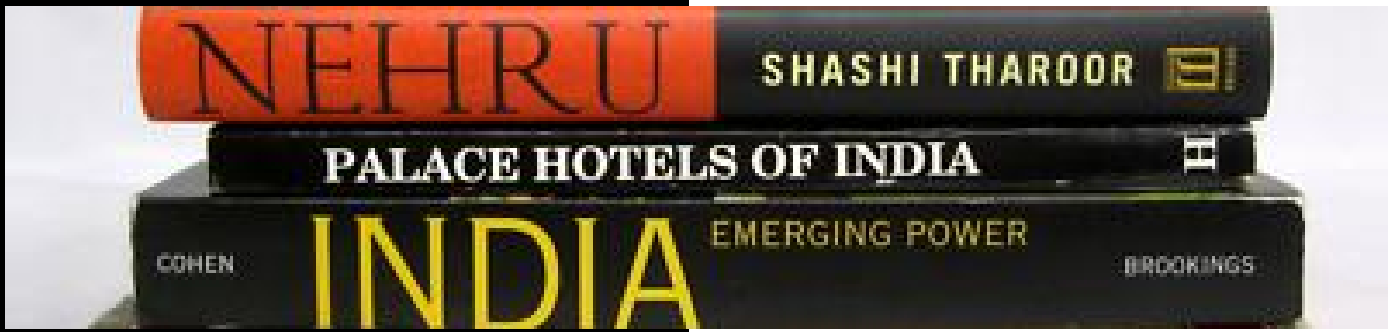
There are moments in one's life when words cease to be mere tools and begin to take on the quality of sacred fire. For me, language has never been just a string of sounds or a set of grammatical conventions; it has been my sanctuary, my rebellion, my curiosity, and my confession. It has whispered comfort in times of despair and offered me a voice when the world demanded silence. The English language, in particular, became both a mirror and a map: it reflected who I was, even as it guided me toward who I could be.

My earliest rendezvous with English was not marked by grand epiphanies but by quiet fascination. In the dimly lit classrooms of my childhood, English textbooks opened a window into lives I'd never lived, tales from distant lands, poems about dreams and despair, fables dressed in strange idioms and new rhythms.

Even then, I sensed that there was something magical in the cadence of a well-turned phrase. I would find myself lingering over lines, mimicking accents I had only heard in films, scribbling sentences in notebooks not because I had to, but because I wanted to. I was seduced not by rules, but by the music of language.







apathy. A single, well-timed pause could speak louder than a paragraph. He transformed my appreciation of language from textual to tonal from reading with the eyes to reading with the ear and the mind.

But most of all, Tharoor taught me a revolutionary kind of respect for my reader. He never diluted his vocabulary, never compromised on complexity. He held his audience to a higher standard, believing that intelligence need not be spoon-fed. This was radical in a world obsessed with oversimplification. He taught me that you honour your listener not by reducing your ideas, but by inviting them to stretch their minds. And so, I began writing not to impress, nor even to express but to elevate. To uplift the conversation. To believe that words could aspire toward meaning, not just messaging.

Of course, my linguistic evolution was not the fruit of one tree alone. There were other mentors along the way. Poets taught me brevity and beauty; novelists, the choreography of plot and dialogue; teachers, the invisible scaffolding of grammar and syntax. But Tharoor alone straddled all these roles: an erudite polymath who could weave literary references into political critique, lace satire into scholarship, and summon intellectual firepower with the flourish of a single sentence. He reminded me that English is not the monopoly of native speakers: it is a legacy we can reclaim, reshape, and reimagine.

For those of us from postcolonial nations, English can be both the language of past subjugation and future liberation. Tharoor's fearless usage of the language, in all its complexity, was a reclaiming of space, a refusal to be linguistically colonised in thought or expression. That, too, shaped me.

Today, when I write, be it a blog, a scholarly paper, a speech, or even a social media caption, there echoes the influence of those early linguistic encounters. I no longer ask, "Will this word be too much?" I ask, "Is this the truest word?" I no longer write for the lowest common denominator; I write to raise the ceiling. My vocabulary may not always be flamboyant, but it is deliberate. My grammar may not be flawless, but it is thoughtful. My sentences are not always complex, but they are alive with care.

In the end, language has not just shaped me; it has saved me. It has anchored me in uncertainty, given wings to my curiosity, and stitched the patchwork of my identity. And in this ever-expanding journey with words, I owe an enduring debt to those who taught me to love the craft and to one mentor in particular, who showed me that words are not weapons or ornaments, but instruments of insight.

Thanks to them, I do not merely speak English, I inhabit it. I do not merely write in it, I think in it. And in this dwelling of diction and dreams, I continue to build my home, one word at a time.

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# शब्द:- ज्यांनी मला घडवले.

भाषेचे मार्गदर्शक आणि शिक्षक देखिल.

आपल्या आयुष्यात काही क्षण असे येतात, जेव्हा शब्द फक्त उच्चार नसतात, तर आपल्या हृदयात आत कोठेतरी खोलवर पोचणाऱ्या भावना असतात.

व्याकरणांचे नियम, किंवा कागदावर लिहिलेली अक्षरे म्हणजे भाषा, अशी माझी कधीच समजूत नव्हती. भाषा म्हणजे माझ्यासाठी, माझी हक्काची जागा, मला पडलेले

प्रश्न, माझे कुतूहल, आणि मी मिळवलेली उत्तरेही. माझी साथ द्यायला जेव्हा कोणी नव्हतं, सर्व जग मला गप्प बसायला सांगत होतं, तेव्हा हीच भाषा माझ्या सोबत होती, आणि तीच माझी शक्ती होती.

खरं सांगायचं तर, इंग्रजीशी माझी ओळख काही उदात्त उद्देशाने किंवा फारशी दिमाखात झाली नाही. बालपणीच्या शाळेच्या वर्गात, इंग्रजी पुस्तके मला मी कधीच गेली नव्हती, अशा अद्भुत जगात घेऊन जात होती. अनोख्या गोष्टी होत्या, देशोदेशीच्या कथा, कविता, स्वप्न --- सगळं काही नविन होतं. पण त्या शब्दांत एक प्रकारची लय होती, संगीत होते. त्या ओळी मी पुनःपुन्हा वाचायचो, चित्रपटात ऐकलेल्या उच्चारांची नक्कल करायचो, आणि शब्दांशी खेळ खेळायचो, ते फक्त शिकायचं म्हणून नव्हे, तर मनापासून करावंसं वाटत असे म्हणून.

मोठा होत गेलो, तसतंस हे आकर्षण एका वेगळ्याच उर्मिमध्ये बदललं. मला इंग्रजी भाषा येते, ह्यातच समाधान न मानता, मला ती भाषा सखोलपणे समजून घ्यायची होती. काही लोक शब्द असे वापरतात की त्यातून विचार स्पष्ट होतात, भावना ठामपणे उमटतात. त्यांचं बोलणं म्हणजे फक्त संवाद नसून एक अनुभव असतो. मी अशा लोकांचे निरीक्षण करत होतो.

याच दरम्यान मी शशी थरूर यांना पहिल्यांदा ऐकलं. ते एक भाषण नव्हतं, तर एक मंत्र होता. इंग्रजी वसाहतवादावरच्या त्यांच्या भाषणाने मी प्रभावित झालो. थक्क झालो. त्यांच्या आवाजात ताकद होतीच, पण त्यापेक्षा अधिक ताकद त्यांच्या शब्दांत होती.

"Expiation", "Apotheosis", "Perfidious" हे शब्द त्यांनी केवळ हुशारी दाखवण्यासाठी वापरले नाहीत, तर स्पष्टपणे, खोलवर परिपूर्ण अर्थ पोचवण्यासाठी वापरले. त्याच क्षणी समजलं,--





शब्द सोपे असावेत अशी गरज नाही :ते प्रामाणिक, सळसळते, आणि प्रभावी असावेत, एवढंच महत्वाचे आहे.

थरूर यांचं बोलणं माझ्यासाठी जणू शिक्षण देणाऱ्या शाळेप्रमाणे बनलं. त्यांच्या भाषणाचे व्हिडीओ मी पुन्हा पुन्हा ऐकले, टीपणं घेतली, त्यांचे लेख वाचले, पुस्तकं वाचली. त्यांच्या प्रत्येक वाक्यात विचार होता. शैली होती. मनःपूर्वक असे ते लेखन होते.

त्यात मोठमोठे शब्द होते, पण त्यामुळे कुठेही भाषेला जडपणा, गोंधळलेपणा नव्हता. शब्द हे सजावटीसाठी नसून, ते अर्थ निर्माण करतात, हे थरूर यांनी शिकवले.

त्यांच्या प्रभावामुळे मी शब्दकोष वापरायला सुरवात केली. नवनवीन शब्द, त्यांचा इतिहास, शब्दांचा वापर, संदर्भ सगळं काही लक्षात ठेवत गेलो. या मध्ये सर्वात मोठा बदल झाला तो विचारात!

भाषा ही तुमच्या विचारांची स्पष्टता ठरवते. जेवढं नेमकं तुम्ही एखाद्या गोष्टीचं वर्णन करता, तेवढं ती भाषा समजण्याची तुमची क्षमता वाढते. हे श्री. थरूर यांनी शिकवलं.

श्री. थरूर यांच्याकडून मी फक्त शब्दसंग्रह वाढवायला शिकलो नाही, तर उत्तम वक्तृत्वकला शिकलो. नेमकेपणाने कधी, काय बोलायचं, वाक्यरचना कशी करायची, शब्दांवर कुठे वजन द्यायला हवे, बोलताना कुठे थांबायचं, हे सर्व मला त्यांच्यामुळे समजले.

त्यांच्यामुळे मला एक मोठा चांगला धडा मिळाला, तो म्हणजे श्रोत्यांना किंवा वाचकांना चांगले वाटावे, त्यांचा आदर करावा म्हणून सगळं सोपं करून देणं नव्हे. त्यापेक्षा त्यांच्या विचारांची व्याप्ती वाढवण्यासाठी संधी देणे म्हणजे त्यांचा सन्मान करणे होय.

आणि म्हणूनच मी लिहायला सुरवात केली.

कोणावर छाप पाडण्यासाठी नाही,

अगदी व्यक्त होण्यासाठी सुद्धा नाही, केवळ आणि केवळ संवादाचा, भाषेच्या अदानप्रदान प्रक्रियेचा स्तर उंचावण्यासाठीच.

अर्थातच श्री थरूर हे माझे एकमेव गुरु नव्हते.

खूप लोक भेटले, लेखक, शिक्षक, कवी, बरेचजण. त्यांनी लिहिणं, बोलणं, विचार करणं शिकवलं. तरीही, ह्या सर्व कला एकवटलेल्या आहेत असे श्री. थरूर एकमेव होते. खरोखरच बहुगुणी व्यक्तिमत्व! त्यांच्या व्यक्तिमत्वात राजकारण, विनोद, साहित्य, ज्ञान यांचा सुरेख मिलाफ होता.

श्री. थरूर यांच्यामुळे मला जाणीव झाली, की इंग्रजी फक्त "त्यांची " भाषा नसून, ती आपलीही आहे. ती आपण चांगली आत्मसात करू शकतो. नव्याने वापरू शकतो. इंग्रजांच्या वसाहती जेथे जेथे होत्या, त्या त्या देशांत ती जबरदस्तीने लादलेली भाषा होती, पण आता तीच भाषा मुक्ततेची भाषा होऊ शकते. थरूर यांची इंग्रजीवरची पकड, त्या भाषेचा वापर म्हणजे स्वतःचे स्वातंत्र्य परत मिळवण्याचे प्रतीकच जणू

आज आता मी जे काही लिहतो, शोधनिबंध, भाषण, स्पुट, अथवा एखादी साधीशी पोस्ट, तेव्हा त्यावर या सुरवातीच्या अनुभवांचा ठसा उमटलेला असतो. आता माझ्या मनात कधीच येत नाही की, हा शब्द जास्त चपखल बसेल का? उलट माझ्या मनात असे येते की हा शब्द जास्त खरा, सच्चा आहे. मी सगळ्यांना समजेल अशा भाषेत लिहीत नाही, तर मी वाचकांच्या क्षमतेवर पूर्ण विश्वास ठेवतो. माझं लेखन आजही परिपूर्ण नाही, पण प्रत्येक वाक्य मला स्फुरलेलं असतं.





ते मनापासून येतं. विचारपूर्वक. चैतन्यदायी.

सारांश काय तर,  
भाषेने फक्त माझ्या आयुष्याला आकार दिला नाही,तर तिने मला सावरलं! डळमळीत अवस्थेत निश्चित आधार दिला, माझ्या जिज्ञासेला योग्य दिशा दिली. आणि माझ्या अस्तित्वाची ओळख दिली.व्यक्तिमत्वाची छाप समाजावर पाडली.

या सर्व भाषेच्या, शब्दांच्या प्रवासात ज्यांनी ज्यांनी मला शब्दांवर प्रेम करायला शिकवलं, त्या सर्वांचा मी ऋणी आहे. त्यातही एका विशेष व्यक्तीचा, ज्या व्यक्तीने मला शिकवलं, शब्द शस्त्र नाहीत, ते फक्त भाषालंकारही नाहीत, तर शब्द हे "अंतरदृष्टीच एक उत्तम साधन आहे.



म्हणूनच मी इंग्रजी फक्त बोलत नाही, ती तर माझ्या मनात खोलवर रुजली आहे. मी फक्त इंग्रजी लिहीत नाही, मी इंग्रजीत विचार करतो.

आणि शब्दांच्या घरात, मी अजूनही रोज एक नविन वीट बांधतो. शब्दभित उभारतो, एक एक शब्द वापरत!!

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# તમે છોડેલું બધું મારામાં જીવંત છે



જો મને ક્યારેય કહેવું પડે કે મારા શબ્દો સાથેનો સંબંધ ક્યાંથી શરૂ થયો, તો હું કહું કે તે મારી મા પાસેથી — મારી મા. એણે ક્યારેય ઔપચારિક રીતે બેઠા રહીને શીખવાડ્યું નથી, પણ એની વાતોમાં, વાર્તાઓમાં, અને ઘરકામ કરતી વખતે ગાતા ગાતા — આ બધું જ મારી શીખવાની રીત હતી.

ત્યારે મને ખબર પડી નહોતી કે એના પણ પોતાના સપના હતાં. પોલિટિકલ સાયન્સમાં એમનું પી.એચ.ડી. ચાલુ હતું. એણે અભ્યાસ ગમતો હતો, શિક્ષણ પ્રત્યે જુસ્સો હતો — એનું જીવન કદાચ કક્ષામાં શીખવવા જવાનું હતું. પણ જ્યારે હું એની જીવનમાં આવી, ત્યારે એણે બધું છોડી દીધું. એણે ક્યારેય ફરિયાદ કરી નથી, પણ આજે સમજાય છે કે કેટલું મુશ્કેલ હતું.

એને સંગીત પણ ખૂબ જ ગમતું. હિન્દુસ્તાની ક્લાસિકલ મ્યુઝિકમાં એની તાલીમ હતી. એનો અવાજ એવો મધુર અને નિયંત્રિત કે કોઈ પણ જગ્યાએ લોકો સાંભળી ને અટકી જાય. એણે પણ મોટા સ્ટેજ પર ગાવું જોઈએ એવું હતું, પણ એના સપનાઓ પણ એણે પાશે મૂકી દીધાં.

પણ એ શીખવતી રહી. શબ્દો કેમ બોલવા, વિચારીને બોલવું, શબ્દોની અસર શું થતી હોય છે — આ બધું એના પાસેથી શીખ્યું. એણે ગાતી વખતે, વાત કરતી વખતે, કે મારી ભૂલ સુધારતી વખતે — એ બધા પાઠ હતાં.

આજે પણ જ્યારે હું કંઈ લખું કે બોલું, ત્યારે એનો અવાજ મને અંદરથી સાંભળાય છે. એના વિરામ, એમાંની ધીરજ, એમાંની 'I' થમ — બધું એમાં છે. ક્યારેક વિચારું કે જો એ પોતાનાં સપનાઓ પાંખ આપતાં, તો શું બની હોત? પ્રોફેસર? કોઈ પ્રસિદ્ધ ગાયિકા?

પણ એણે બધું છોડી મને ઘડ્યું — શબ્દે શબ્દે, પગલે પગલે. એણે ક્યારેય એને બલિદાન કહ્યું નથી, પણ મને ખબર છે કે એ હતું.

મારા શબ્દોમાં જો કોઈ ગ્રેસ હોય, વિચારોમાં જો કોઈ 'I' થમ હોય — તો એ એટલા માટે કે હું એનો અવાજ આજેય અંદરથી સાંભળું છું.





# WHAT SHE LEFT BEHIND LIVES IN ME

If I ever have to explain where my relationship with words really began, I'd say it started with my mother — my Maa. Not in a formal, sit-down way, but in the way she spoke to me, told stories, sang around the house.

What I didn't see then was that Maa had her own dreams. She was deep into her PhD in Political Science. She loved studying, loved teaching — she was meant to become someone important in academia. But when I came into her life, she left it all behind. She didn't say much about it, but I know now it wasn't easy.

She also had music. She was trained in Hindustani classical music, with a voice so rich, so controlled, it could've easily filled a concert hall. She could have become a respected classical singer, but she put that dream away too.



Still, she kept teaching me, without making it obvious. She taught me how to speak properly, how to think before I speak, how words can build or break. I didn't realise it back then, but every song she hummed, every story she told, every time she corrected my grammar — those were her lessons in disguise.

Now when I write or speak, I hear her voice in my head. The pauses, the patience, the rhythm — it's all her. Sometimes I wonder what she could've been if she had followed her own path — a professor, a renowned singer maybe. But instead, she built me, word by word, lesson by lesson.

She never calls it a sacrifice, but I know it was. And if I have any grace in my words, any rhythm in my thoughts — it's because I carry her voice within me.

**Ms. Twisha Ray**  
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